Printed by: filippo.fiz@uptoten.it. Printing is for personal, private use only. No part of this book may be reproduced or transmitted without publisher's prior permission. Violators will be prosecuted.

Seventeenth-century treatises and other sources of political authority describe areas of sovereignty rather than illustrate them using maps.

•

During the fifteenth century in Europe, mapmakers simplified the borders of sovereignty by drawing clear lines of demarcation between political powers.

•

Sascha: The attempt to ban parliament's right to pass directed-spending bills—bills that contain provisions specifically funding the favorite projects of some powerful politicians—is antidemocratic. Our nation's constitution requires that money be drawn from our treasury only when so stipulated by laws passed by parliament, the branch of government most directly representative of the citizens. This requirement is based on the belief that exercising the power to spend public resources involves the ultimate exercise of state authority and that therefore _____.

Which of the following most logically completes Sascha's argument?

A. designating funding specifically for the favorite projects of some powerful politicians should be considered antidemocratic

B. the right to exercise such a power should belong exclusively to the branch of government most directly representative of the citizens

C. exercising the power to spend public resources is in most cases—but not all—protected by the constitution

D. modifications to any spending bills should be considered expenditures authorized by law

E. only officials who are motivated by concerns for reelection should retain that power

•

Boreal owls range over a much larger area than do other owls of similar size. Scientists have hypothesized that **it is scarcity of prey that leads the owls to range so widely.** This hypothesis would be hard to confirm directly, since it is not possible to produce a sufficiently accurate count of the populations of small mammals inhabiting the forests where boreal owls live. Careful study of owl behavior has, however, shown that **boreal owls do range over larger areas when they live in regions where food of the sort eaten by small mammals is comparatively sparse.** This indicates that the scientists' hypothesis is not sheer speculation.

In the argument given, the two **boldfaced** portions play which of the following roles?

A. The first presents an explanatory hypothesis; the second states the main conclusion of the argument.

B. The first presents an explanatory hypothesis; the second presents evidence tending to support this hypothesis.

C. The first presents an explanatory hypothesis; the second presents evidence to support an alternative explanation.

D. The first describes a position that the argument opposes; the second presents evidence to undermine the support for the position being opposed.

E. The first describes a position that the argument opposes; the second states the main conclusion of the argument.

•

Cognitive scientist: Using the pioneering work of comparative psychologist Gordon Gallup as a model, several studies have investigated animals' capacity for mirror self-recognition (MSR). Most animals exposed to a mirror respond only with social behavior, such as aggression. However, in the case of the great apes, repeated exposure to mirrors leads to self-directed behaviors, such as exploring the inside of the mouth, suggesting that these animals recognize the reflection as an image of self. The implication of these studies is that the great apes have a capacity for self-awareness unique among nonhuman species.

The cognitive scientist makes which of the following assumptions in the argument above?

A. Gallup's work has established that the great apes have a capacity for MSR unique among nonhuman species.

B. If an animal does not have the capacity for MSR, it does not have the capacity for self-awareness.

C. If a researcher exposes an animal to a mirror and that animal exhibits social behavior, that animal is incapable of being self-aware.

D. When exposed to a mirror, all animals display either social behavior or self-directed behavior.

DO NOT COPY filippo.fiz@uptoten.it

Printed by: filippo.fiz@uptoten.it. Printing is for personal, private use only. No part of this book may be reproduced or transmitted without publisher's prior permission. Violators will be prosecuted.

D. When exposed to a mirror, all animals display either social behavior or self-directed behavior.

E. Animals that do not exhibit MSR may demonstrate a capacity for self-awareness in other ways.

•

Last year a record number of new manufacturing jobs were created. Will this year bring another record? Well, any new manufacturing job is created either within an existing company or by the start-up of a new company. **Within existing firms, new jobs have been created this year at well below last year's record pace.** At the same time, there is considerable evidence that the number of new companies starting up will be no higher this year than it was last year, and **there is no reason to think that the new companies starting up this year will create more jobs per company than did last year's start-ups.** So clearly, the number of new jobs created this year will fall short of last year's record.

In the argument given, the two portions in **boldface** play which of the following roles?

A. The first is a claim that the argument challenges; the second is an explicit assumption on which that challenge is based.

B. The first is a claim that the argument challenges; the second is a judgment advanced in support of the main conclusion of the argument.

C. The first provides evidence in support of the main conclusion of the argument; the second is an objection that has been raised against that main conclusion.

D. The first provides evidence in support of the main conclusion of the argument; the second is a judgment advanced in support of that main conclusion.

E. The first and the second are each claims that have been advanced in support of a position that the argument opposes.

•

A study of ticket sales at a summer theater festival found that people who bought tickets to individual plays had a no-show rate of less than 1 percent, while those who paid in advance for all ten plays being performed that summer had a no-show rate of nearly 30 percent. This may be at least in part because the greater the awareness customers retain about the cost of an item, the more likely they are to use it.

Which of the following would, if true, best serve as an alternative explanation of the results of the study?

A. The price per ticket was slightly cheaper for those who bought all ten tickets in advance.

B. Many people who attended the theater festival believed strongly that they should support it financially.

C. Those who attended all ten plays became eligible for a partial refund.

D. Usually, people who bought tickets to individual plays did so immediately prior to each performance that they attended.

E. People who arrived just before the performance began could not be assured of obtaining seats in a preferred location.

•

Although there is no record of poet Edmund Spenser's parentage, we do know that as a youth, Spenser attended the Merchant Tailors' School in London for a period between 1560 and 1570. Records from this time indicate that the Merchant Tailors' Guild then had only three members named Spenser: Robert Spenser, listed as a gentleman; Nicholas Spenser, elected the Guild's Warden in 1568; and John Spenser, listed as a "journeyman cloth-maker." Of these, the last was likely the least affluent of the three—and most likely Edmund's father, since school accounting records list Edmund as a scholar who attended the school at a reduced fee.

Which of the following is an assumption on which the argument depends?

A. Anybody in sixteenth-century London who made clothing professionally would have had to be a member of the Merchant Tailors' Guild.

B. The fact that Edmund Spenser attended the Merchant Tailors' School did not necessarily mean that he planned to become a tailor.

C. No member of the Guild could become Guild warden in sixteenth-century London unless he was a gentleman.

D. Most of those whose fathers were members of the Merchant Tailors' Guild were students at the Merchant Tailors' School.

DO NOT COPY filippo.fiz@uptoten.it

Printed by: filippo.fiz@uptoten.it. Printing is for personal, private use only. No part of this book may be reproduced or transmitted without publisher's prior permission. Violators will be prosecuted.

Tailors' School.

E. The Merchant Tailors' School did not reduce its fees for the children of the more affluent Guild members.

•

Hea Sook: One should not readily believe urban legends. Most legends are propagated because the moral lesson underlying them supports a political agenda. People will repeat a tale if it fits their purpose. They may not deliberately spread untruths, but neither are they particularly motivated to investigate deeply to determine if the tale they are telling is true.

Kayla: But people would not repeat stories that they did not believe were true. Therefore, one can safely assume that if a story has been repeated by enough people, then it is more likely to be true.

Kayla's reply is most vulnerable to the criticism that it

A. does not specify how many people need to repeat a story before someone is justified in believing it

B. overstates the significance of political agendas in the retelling of stories

C. fails to address the claim that people will not verify the truth of a story that fits their purpose

D. implicitly supports the claim that the people repeating legends are not deliberately spreading untruths

E. cannot distinguish people's motivations for repeating urban legends from their motivations for repeating other types of story

•

Rainwater contains hydrogen of a heavy form called deuterium. The deuterium content of wood reflects the deuterium content of rainwater available to trees during their growth. Wood from trees that grew between 16,000 and 24,000 years ago in North America contains significantly more deuterium than wood from trees growing today. But water trapped in several North American caves that formed during that same early period contains significantly less deuterium than rainwater in North America contains today.

Which of the following, if true, most helps to reconcile the two findings?

A. There is little deuterium in the North American caves other than the deuterium in the water trapped there.

B. Exposure to water after a tree has died does not change the deuterium content of the wood.

C. Industrialization in North America over the past 100 years has altered the deuterium content of rain.

D. Trees draw on shallow groundwater from rain that falls during their growth, whereas water trapped in caves may have fallen as rainwater thousands of years before the caves formed.

E. Wood with a high deuterium content is no more likely to remain preserved for long periods than is wood with a low deuterium content.

•

Enforcement of local speed limits through police monitoring has proven unsuccessful in the town of Ardane. In many nearby towns, speed humps (raised areas of pavement placed across residential streets, about 300 feet apart) have reduced traffic speeds on residential streets by 20 to 25 percent. In order to reduce traffic speed and thereby enhance safety in residential neighborhoods, Ardane's transportation commission plans to install multiple speed humps in those neighborhoods.

Which of the following, if true, identifies a potentially serious drawback to the plan for installing speed humps in Ardane?

A. On residential streets without speed humps, many vehicles travel at speeds more than 25 percent above the posted speed limit.

B. Because of their high weight, emergency vehicles such as fire trucks and ambulances must slow almost to a stop at speed humps.

C. The residential speed limit in Ardane is higher than that of the nearby towns where speed humps were installed.

D. Motorists who are not familiar with the streets in Ardane's residential districts would be likely to encounter the speed humps unawares unless warned by signs and painted indicators.

E. Bicyclists generally prefer that speed humps be constructed so as to leave a space on the side of the road where bicycles can travel without going over the humps.

DO NOT COPY filippo.fiz@uptoten.it

Printed by: filippo.fiz@uptoten.it. Printing is for personal, private use only. No part of this book may be reproduced or transmitted without publisher's prior permission. Violators will be prosecuted.

bicycles can travel without going over the ramps.

•

Which of the choices most logically completes the following argument?

NowNews, although still the most popular magazine covering cultural events in Kalopolis, has recently suffered a significant drop in advertising revenue because of falling circulation. Many readers have begun buying a competing magazine that, at 50 cents per copy, costs less than *NowNews* at $1.50 per copy. In order to boost circulation and thus increase advertising revenue, *NowNews*'s publisher has proposed making it available at no charge. However, this proposal has a serious drawback, since _____.

A. those Kalopolis residents with the greatest interest in cultural events are regular readers of both magazines.

B. one reason *NowNews*'s circulation fell was that its competitor's reporting on cultural events was superior.

C. the newsstands and stores that currently sell *NowNews* will no longer carry it if it is being given away for free.

D. at present, 10 percent of the total number of copies of each issue of *NowNews* are distributed free to students on college campuses in the Kalopolis area.

E. *NowNews*'s competitor would begin to lose large amounts of money if it were forced to lower its cover price.

•

Over the last five years, demand for hotel rooms in Cenopolis has increased significantly, as has the average price Cenopolis hotels charge for rooms. These trends are projected to continue for the next several years. In response to this economic forecast, Centennial Commercial, a real estate developer, is considering a plan to convert several unoccupied office buildings it owns in Cenopolis into hotels in order to maximize its revenues from these properties.

Which of the following would it be most useful for Centennial Commercial to know in evaluating the plan it is considering?

A. Whether the population of Cenopolis is expected to grow in the next several years

B. Whether demand for office space in Cenopolis is projected to increase in the near future

C. Whether the increased demand for hotel rooms, if met, is likely to lead to an increase in the demand for other travel-related services

D. Whether demand for hotel rooms has also increased in other cities where Centennial Commercial owns office buildings

E. Whether, on average, hotels that have been created by converting office buildings have fewer guest rooms than do hotels that were built as hotels

•

Farmer: Several people in the past few years have claimed to have seen a mountain lion in the suburban outskirts—the latest just last month—and, while mountain lions were thought to have been driven from this entire region about twenty years ago, there is no reason for the people who reported seeing a mountain lion to have deliberately concocted a false report. Therefore, local wildlife managers should begin to urgently address the mountain lion's presence.

Which of the following would, if true, most seriously weaken the farmer's argument?

A. Farmers in the suburban outskirts mostly raise cattle and hogs, which when fully grown are generally not attacked by mountain lions.

B. Mountain lions are dissimilar in size and color to other wild animals found near the suburban outskirts.

C. No person who claimed to have seen a mountain lion had anyone else with them at the purported sighting.

D. There have been no regional reports in the past year of mountain lions migrating to the area.

E. Recent surveys show that more than half of the people in the region report that they have never seen a mountain lion before.

•

The heavy traffic in Masana is a growing drain on the city's economy—the clogging of the streets of the central business district alone cost the economy more than $1.2 billion over the past year. In order to address this problem, officials plan to introduce congestion pricing, by which drivers would pay to enter the city's most heavily trafficked areas during the busiest times of the day.

DO NOT COPY filippo.fiz@uptoten.it

Printed by: filippo.fiz@uptoten.it. Printing is for personal, private use only. No part of this book may be reproduced or transmitted without publisher's prior permission. Violators will be prosecuted.

areas during the busiest times of the day.

Which of the following, if true, would most strongly indicate that the plan will be a success?

A. Approximately one-fifth of the vehicles in the central business district are in transit from one side of the city to the other.

B. Planners expect that, without congestion pricing, traffic in Masana is likely to grow by 6 percent in the next five years.

C. In other urban areas, congestion pricing has strongly encouraged carpooling (sharing of rides by private commuters).

D. Several studies have shown that a reduction in traffic of 15 percent in Masana could result in 5,500 or more new jobs.

E. Over 30 percent of the vehicles in the city's center are occupied by more than one person.

•

Economist: The most economically efficient way to reduce emissions of air pollutants is to tax them in proportion to the damage they are likely to cause. But in Country Y, many serious pollutants are untaxed and unregulated, and policy makers strongly oppose new taxes. Therefore, the best way to achieve a reduction in air pollutant emissions in Country Y would be to institute fixed upper limits on them.

Which of the following is an assumption of the economist's argument?

A. Policy makers in Country Y oppose all new taxes equally strongly, regardless of any benefits they may provide.

B. Country Y's air pollutant emissions would not fall significantly if they were taxed in proportion to the damage they are likely to cause.

C. Policy makers in Country Y strongly favor reductions in air pollutant emissions.

D. Country Y's policy makers believe that air pollutant emissions should be reduced with maximum economic efficiency.

E. Policy makers in Country Y do not oppose setting fixed upper limits on air pollutant emissions as strongly as they oppose new taxes.

•

A study of high blood pressure treatments found certain meditation techniques and the most commonly prescribed drugs are equally effective if the selected treatment is followed as directed over the long term. Half the patients given drugs soon stop taking them regularly, whereas 80 percent of the study's participants who were taught meditation techniques were still regularly using them five years later. Therefore, the meditation treatment is the one likely to produce the best results.

Which of the following, if true, most seriously weakens the argument?

A. People who have high blood pressure are usually advised by their physicians to make changes in diet that have been found in many cases to reduce the severity of the condition.

B. The participants in the study were selected in part on the basis of their willingness to use meditation techniques.

C. Meditation techniques can reduce the blood pressure of people who do not suffer from high blood pressure.

D. Some of the participants in the study whose high blood pressure was controlled through meditation techniques were physicians.

E. Many people with dangerously high blood pressure are unaware of their condition.

•

Many industrialized nations are trying to reduce atmospheric concentrations of carbon dioxide, a gas released by the burning of fossil fuels. One proposal is to replace conventional cement, which is made with calcium carbonate, by a new "eco-cement." This new cement, made with magnesium carbonate, absorbs large amounts of carbon dioxide when exposed to the atmosphere. Therefore, using eco-cement for new concrete building projects will significantly help reduce atmospheric concentrations of carbon dioxide.

Which of the following, if true, most strengthens the argument?

A. The cost of magnesium carbonate, currently greater than the cost of calcium carbonate, probably will fall as more magnesium carbonate is used in cement manufacture.

DO NOT COPY filippo.fiz@uptoten.it

Printed by: filippo.fiz@uptoten.it. Printing is for personal, private use only. No part of this book may be reproduced or transmitted without publisher's prior permission. Violators will be prosecuted.

more magnesium carbonate is used in cement manufacture.

B. Eco-cement is strengthened when absorbed carbon dioxide reacts with the cement.

C. Before the development of eco-cement, magnesium-based cement was considered too susceptible to water erosion to be of practical use.

D. The manufacture of eco-cement uses considerably less fossil fuel per unit of cement than the manufacture of conventional cement does.

E. Most building-industry groups are unaware of the development or availability of eco-cement.

•

Professor: A marine biologist argues that transmission of sea lice from farm salmon to wild salmon is unlikely in the Broughton Archipelago, British Columbia, citing numerous studies suggesting that salinities less than 30 parts per thousand are unfavorable to sea-lice survival. The biologist concludes that the archipelago's 25–30 parts per thousand salinity range between March and June, the critical period for wild salmon migration, tends to suppress sea-lice proliferation. But a review of the literature shows that salinities of 25–30 parts per thousand in combination with British Columbia's cool spring temperatures favor the flourishing of sea lice.

In this passage, the professor attempts to undermine the biologist's argument by

A. pointing out that a condition claimed to be necessary for sea-lice survival is not sufficient for it

B. citing studies that suggest that salinity levels were not measured reliably

C. claiming that there is evidence showing that one of its premises is false

D. questioning the reliability of the biologist's scientific sources

E. showing that its conclusion is inconsistent with its premises

•

Advertisement: When your car's engine is running at its normal operating temperature, any major brand of motor oil will protect it about as well as Tuff does. When the engine is cold, it is a different story: Tuff motor oil flows better at lower temperatures than its major competitors do. So, if you want your car's engine to have maximum protection, you should use Tuff.

Which of the following, if true, most strengthens the argument in the advertisement?

A. Tuff motor oil provides above-average protection for engines that happen to overheat.

B. Tuff motor oil is periodically supplied free of charge to automobile manufacturers to use in factory-new cars.

C. Tuff motor oil's share of the engine oil market peaked three years ago.

D. Tuff motor oil, like any motor oil, is thicker and flows less freely at cold temperatures than at hot temperatures.

E. Tuff motor oil is manufactured at only one refinery and shipped from there to all markets.

•

Linguist: In English, the past is described as "behind" and the future "ahead," whereas in Aymara, the past is "ahead" and the future "behind." Research indicates that English speakers sway backward when discussing the past and forward when discussing the future. Conversely, Aymara speakers gesture forward with their hands when discussing the past and backward when discussing the future. These bodily movements, therefore, suggest that the language one speaks affects how one mentally visualizes time.

The linguist's reasoning depends on assuming which of the following?

A. At least some Aymara speakers sway forward when discussing the past and backward when discussing the future.

B. Most people mentally visualize time as running either forward or backward.

C. Not all English and Aymara speakers tend to sway or gesture forward or backward when discussing the present.

D. How people move when discussing the future correlates to some extent with how they mentally visualize time.

E. The researchers also examined the movements of at least some speakers of languages other than English and Aymara discussing the past and the future.

•

DO NOT COPY filippo.fiz@uptoten.it

Printed by: filippo.fiz@uptoten.it. Printing is for personal, private use only. No part of this book may be reproduced or transmitted without publisher's prior permission. Violators will be prosecuted.

•

The Testament of William Thorpe was published around 1530 as an appendix to Thorpe's longer *Examination*. Many scholars, however, doubt the attribution of the *Testament* to Thorpe because, whereas the *Examination* is dated 1406, the *Testament* is dated 1460. One scholar has recently argued that the 1460 date be amended to 1409, based on the observation that when these numbers are expressed as Roman numerals, MCCCCLX and MCCCCIX, it becomes easy to see how the dates might have become confused through scribal error.

Which of the following, if true, would most support the scholar's hypothesis concerning the date of the *Testament*?

A. The sole evidence that historians have had that William Thorpe died no earlier than 1460 was the presumed date of publication of the *Testament*.

B. In the preface to the 1530 publication, the editor attributes both works to William Thorpe.

C. Few writers in fifteenth-century England marked dates in their works using only Roman numerals.

D. The *Testament* alludes to a date, "Friday, September 20," as apparently contemporaneous with the writing of the *Testament*, and September 20 fell on a Friday in 1409 but not in 1460.

E. The *Testament* contains few references to historical events that occurred later than 1406.

•

A prominent investor who holds a large stake in the Burton Tool Company has recently claimed that the company is mismanaged, citing as evidence the company's failure to slow down production in response to a recent rise in its inventory of finished products. It is doubtful whether an investor's sniping at management can ever be anything other than counterproductive, but in this case, it is clearly not justified. It is true that **an increased inventory of finished products often indicates that production is outstripping demand**, but in Burton's case it indicates no such thing. Rather, **the increase in inventory is entirely attributable to products that have already been assigned to orders received from customers.**

In the argument given, the two **boldfaced** portions play which of the following roles?

A. The first states a generalization that underlies the position that the argument as a whole opposes; the second provides evidence to show that the generalization does not apply in the case at issue.

B. The first states a generalization that underlies the position that the argument as a whole opposes; the second clarifies the meaning of a specific phrase as it is used in that generalization.

C. The first provides evidence to support the conclusion of the argument as a whole; the second is evidence that has been used to support the position that the argument as a whole opposes.

D. The first provides evidence to support the conclusion of the argument as a whole; the second states that conclusion.

E. The first and the second each provide evidence against the position that the argument as a whole opposes.

•

Kate: The recent decline in numbers of the Tennessee warbler, a North American songbird that migrates each fall to coffee plantations in South America, is due to the elimination of the dense tree cover that formerly was a feature of most South American coffee plantations.

Scott: The population of the spruce budworm, the warbler's favorite prey in North America, has been dropping. This is a more likely explanation of the warbler's decline.

Which of the following, if true, most seriously calls Scott's hypothesis into question?

A. The numbers of the Baltimore oriole, a songbird that does not eat budworms but is as dependent on South American coffee plantations as is the Tennessee warbler, are declining.

B. The spruce budworm population has dropped because of a disease that can infect budworms but not Tennessee warblers.

C. The drop in the population of the spruce budworm is expected to be only temporary.

D. Many Tennessee warblers have begun migrating in the fall to places other than traditional coffee plantations.

E. Although many North American songbirds have declined in numbers, no other species has experienced as great a decline as the Tennessee warbler.

•

DO NOT COPY filippo.fiz@uptoten.it

Printed by: filippo.fiz@uptoten.it. Printing is for personal, private use only. No part of this book may be reproduced or transmitted without publisher's prior permission. Violators will be prosecuted.

•

Advertising by mail has become much less effective, with fewer consumers responding. Because consumers are increasingly overwhelmed by the sheer amount of junk mail they receive, most discard almost all offers without considering them. Thus, an effective way for corporations to improve response rates would be to more carefully target the individuals to whom they mail advertising, thereby cutting down on the amount of junk mail each consumer receives.

Which of the following, if true, would most support the recommendation above?

A. There are cost-effective means by which corporations that currently advertise by mail could improve response rates.

B. Many successful corporations are already carefully targeting the individuals to whom they mail advertising.

C. Any consumer who, immediately after receiving an advertisement by mail, merely glances at it is very likely to discard it.

D. Improvements in the quality of the advertising materials used in mail that is carefully targeted to individuals can improve the response rate for such mail.

E. Response rates to carefully targeted advertisements by mail are considerably higher, on average, than response rates to most other forms of advertising.

•

Petrochemical industry officials have said that the extreme pressure exerted on plant managers during the last five years to improve profits by cutting costs has done nothing to impair the industry's ability to operate safely. However, environmentalists contend that the recent rash of serious oil spills and accidents at petrochemical plants is traceable to cost-cutting measures.

Which of the following, if true, would provide the strongest support for the position held by industry officials?

A. The petrochemical industry benefits if accidents do not occur, since accidents involve risk of employee injury as well as loss of equipment and product.

B. Petrochemical industry unions recently demanded that additional money be spent on safety and environmental protection measures, but the unions readily abandoned those demands in exchange for job security.

C. Despite major cutbacks in most other areas of operation, the petrochemical industry has devoted more of its resources to environmental and safety measures in the last five years than in the preceding five years.

D. There is evidence that the most damaging of the recent oil spills would have been prevented had cost-cutting measures not been instituted.

E. Both the large fines and the adverse publicity generated by the most recent oil spill have prompted the petrochemical industry to increase the resources devoted to oil-spill prevention.

•

A company has developed a new sensing device that, according to the company's claims, detects weak, ultralow-frequency electromagnetic signals associated with a beating heart. These signals, which pass through almost any physical obstruction, are purportedly detected by the device even at significant distances. Therefore, if the company's claims are true, their device will radically improve emergency teams' ability to locate quickly people who are trapped within the wreckage of collapsed buildings.

Which of the following, if true, most strengthens the argument?

A. People trapped within the wreckage of collapsed buildings usually have serious injuries that require prompt medical treatment.

B. The device gives a distinctive reading when the signals it detects come from human beings rather than from any other living beings.

C. Most people who have survived after being trapped in collapsed buildings were rescued within two hours of the building's collapse.

D. Ultralow-frequency signals are not the only electromagnetic signals that can pass through almost any physical obstruction.

E. Extensive training is required in order to operate the device effectively.

-

DO NOT COPY filippo.fiz@uptoten.it

Printed by: filippo.fiz@uptoten.it. Printing is for personal, private use only. No part of this book may be reproduced or transmitted without publisher's prior permission. Violators will be prosecuted.

•

Economist: The price of tap water in our region should be raised drastically. **Supplies in local freshwater reservoirs have been declining for years** because water is being used faster than it can be replenished. Since the price of tap water has been low, **few users have bothered to adopt even easy conservation measures.**

The two sections in **boldface** play which of the following roles in the economist's argument?

A. The first is a conclusion for which support is provided, and which in turn supports the main conclusion; the second is the main conclusion.

B. The first is an observation for which the second provides an explanation; the second is the main conclusion but not the only conclusion.

C. The first is a premise supporting the argument's main conclusion; so is the second.

D. The first is the only conclusion; the second provides an explanation for the first.

E. The first is the main conclusion; the second is a conclusion for which support is provided, and which in turn supports the first.

•

Maize contains the vitamin niacin, but not in a form the body can absorb. Pellagra is a disease that results from niacin deficiency. When maize was introduced into southern Europe from the Americas in the eighteenth century, it quickly became a dietary staple, and many Europeans who came to subsist primarily on maize developed pellagra. Pellagra was virtually unknown at that time in the Americas, however, even among people who subsisted primarily on maize.

Which of the following, if true, most helps to explain the contrasting incidence of pellagra described above?

A. Once introduced into southern Europe, maize became popular with landowners because of its high yields relative to other cereal crops.

B. Maize grown in the Americas contained more niacin than maize grown in Europe did.

C. Traditional ways of preparing maize in the Americas convert maize's niacin into a nutritionally useful form.

D. In southern Europe, many of the people who consumed maize also ate niacin-rich foods.

E. Before the discovery of pellagra's link with niacin, it was widely believed the disease was an infection that could be transmitted from person to person.

•

Mayor: False alarms from home security systems waste so much valuable police time that in many communities, police have stopped responding to alarms from homes whose systems frequently produce false alarms. This policy reduces wastage of police time but results in a loss of protection for some residents. To achieve a comparable reduction in wastage without reducing protection for residents, the council has enacted a measure to fine residents for repeated false alarms.

Which of the following, if true, casts the most doubt on whether the measure enacted by the council will achieve its goal?

A. A fine in the amount planned by the council will not cover the expenses police typically incur when they respond to a false alarm.

B. Homes equipped with security systems are far less likely to be broken into than are homes without security systems.

C. The threat of fines is likely to cause many residents to deactivate their security systems.

D. The number of home security systems is likely to increase dramatically over the next five years.

E. Many home security systems have never produced false alarms.

•

Excavation of the house of a third-century Camarnian official revealed that he had served four magistrates—public officials who administer the law—over his thirty-year public career, in four provincial capital cities. However, given the Camarnian administrative system of that era, it is unclear whether he served them simultaneously, as a traveling administrator living for part of the year in each provincial capital, or else did so sequentially, leaving one magistrate after several years to join another.

DO NOT COPY filippo.fiz@uptoten.it

Printed by: filippo.fiz@uptoten.it. Printing is for personal, private use only. No part of this book may be reproduced or transmitted without publisher's prior permission. Violators will be prosecuted.

Which of the following would, if found in the excavation, most likely help reveal the pattern of the official's administrative service?

A. Maps and documents describing each of the four provincial capitals

B. A cache of the official's documents related to work from early in his career

C. A set of cups of a type made only in the city of the first magistrate whom the official is known to have served

D. Several pieces of furniture in the styles of two of the provincial capital cities

E. Heavy clothing appropriate only for the coldest of the four cities

•

In 1563, in Florence's Palazzo Vecchio, Giorgio Vasari built in front of an existing wall a new wall on which he painted a mural. Investigators recently discovered a gap between Vasari's wall and the original, large enough to have preserved anything painted on the original. Historians believe that Leonardo da Vinci had painted, but left unfinished, a mural on the original wall; some historians had also believed that by 1563, the mural had been destroyed. However, it is known that in the late 1560s, when renovating another building, Santa Maria Novella, Vasari built a façade over its frescoes, and the frescoes were thereby preserved. Thus, Leonardo's Palazzo Vecchio mural probably still exists behind Vasari's wall.

Which of the following is an assumption on which the argument depends?

A. Leonardo rarely if ever destroyed artworks that he left unfinished.

B. Vasari was likely unaware that the mural in the Palazzo Vecchio had willingly been abandoned by Leonardo.

C. Vasari probably would not have built the Palazzo Vecchio wall with a gap behind it except to preserve something behind the new wall.

D. Leonardo would probably have completed the Palazzo Vecchio mural if he had had the opportunity to do so.

E. When Vasari preserved the frescoes of Santa Maria Novella he did so secretly.

•

Coffee shop owner: A large number of customers will pay at least the fair market value for a cup of coffee, even if there is no formal charge. Some will pay more than this out of appreciation of the trust that is placed in them. And our total number of customers is likely to increase. We could therefore improve our net cash flow by implementing an honor system in which customers pay what they wish for coffee by depositing money in a can.

Manager: We're likely to lose money on this plan. Many customers would cheat the system, paying a very small sum or nothing at all.

Which of the following, if true, would best support the owner's plan, in light of the manager's concern?

A. The new system, if implemented, would increase the number of customers.

B. By roasting its own coffee, the shop has managed to reduce the difficulties (and cost) of maintaining an inventory of freshly roasted coffee.

C. Many customers stay in the cafe for long stretches of time.

D. The shop makes a substantial profit from pastries and other food bought by the coffee drinkers.

E. No other coffee shop in the area has such a system.

•

Birds have been said to be descended from certain birdlike dinosaur species with which they share distinctive structural features. The fossil record, however, shows that this cannot be so, since there are bird fossils that are much older than the earliest birdlike dinosaur fossils that have been found.

Which of the following is an assumption on which the argument relies?

A. The birdlike dinosaurs have no living descendants.

B. There are no flightless dinosaur species that have the distinctive structural features shared by birds and birdlike dinosaurs.

C. There are no birdlike dinosaur fossils that are older than the bird fossils but have not yet been unearthed.

D. It could not have been the case that some birds were descended from one of the birdlike dinosaur species and

DO NOT COPY filippo.fiz@uptoten.it

Printed by: filippo.fiz@uptoten.it. Printing is for personal, private use only. No part of this book may be reproduced or transmitted without publisher's prior permission. Violators will be prosecuted.

D. It could not have been the case that some birds were descended from one of the birdlike dinosaur species and other birds from another.

E. Birds cannot have been descended from dinosaur species with which the birds do not share the distinctive structural features.

•

The total market value of real estate in Altonville has steadily declined over the past four years. This decline has meant the overall figure on which the city's property tax is based—the assessed value of that real estate—has also declined. Moreover, the percentage of assessed value that was paid as property taxes to the city did not change during this period.

The information above most strongly supports which of the following?

A. Money collected from property taxes provided most of Altonville's revenue during the past four years.

B. The percentage of Altonville's overall revenue that was collected from property taxes did not change over the past four years.

C. Altonville officials had proposed raising property tax rates during the past four years but never did so because of strong opposition from property owners.

D. The total amount of revenue that Altonville has collected from property taxes has declined over the past four years.

E. During the past four years, Altonville officials also did not increase tax rates on other sources of revenue such as retail sales or business profits.

•

Certain groups of Asian snails include both "left-handed" and "right-handed" species, with shells coiling to the left and right, respectively. Some left-handed species have evolved from right-handed ones. Also, researchers found that snail-eating snakes in the same habitat have asymmetrical jaws, allowing them to grasp right-handed snail shells more easily. If these snakes ate more right-handed snails over time, this would have given left-handed snails an evolutionary advantage over right-handed snails, with the left-handed snails eventually becoming a new species. Thus, the snakes' asymmetrical jaws probably helped drive the emergence of the left-handed snail species.

Which of the following would, if true, most strengthen the argument that asymmetrical snake jaws helped drive left-handed snail evolution?

A. In one snake species, the snakes with asymmetrical jaws eat snails, while the snakes with symmetrical jaws do not eat snails.

B. Some species of Asian snails contain either all right-handed snails or all left-handed snails.

C. Anatomical differences prevent left-handed snails from mating easily with right-handed snails.

D. Some right-handed snails in this habitat have shells with a very narrow opening that helps prevent snakes from extracting the snails from inside their shells.

E. Experiments show that the snail-eating snakes in this habitat fail more often in trying to eat left-handed snails than in trying to eat right-handed snails.

•

A moderately large city is redesigning its central downtown area and is considering a plan that would reduce the number of lanes for automobiles and trucks and increase those for bicycles and pedestrians. The

DO NOT COPY filippo.fiz@uptoten.it